

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

ARKANSAS TECH UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: September 25-26, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

ARKANSAS TECH UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL ROUTE

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

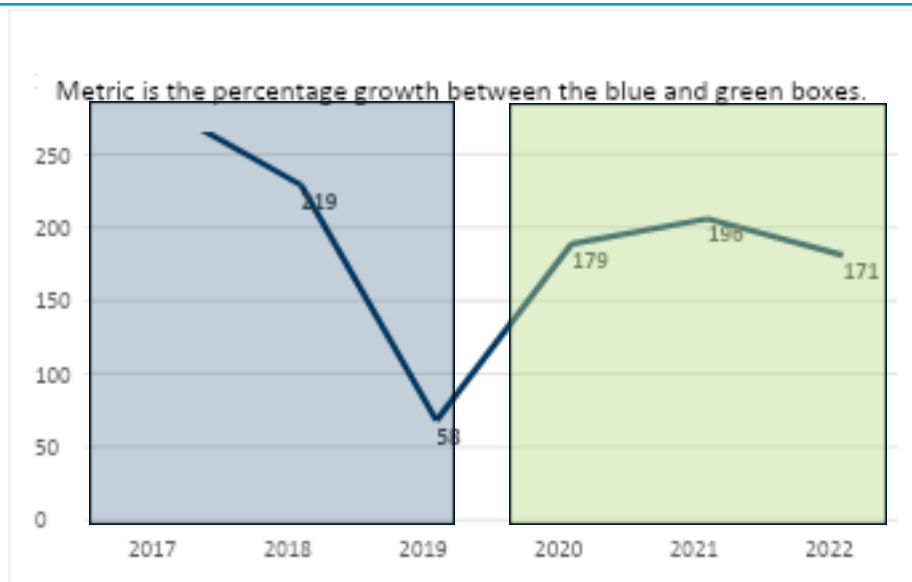
Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	BELOW	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Arkansas Tech University's traditional program candidates have high rates of completion that exceed the state target. Recruiting additional candidates, specifically in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 1.2 a and 1.2b)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The Arkansas Tech Traditional Program's Annual Plan presents a proactive approach to improving Praxis scores and program completion data.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

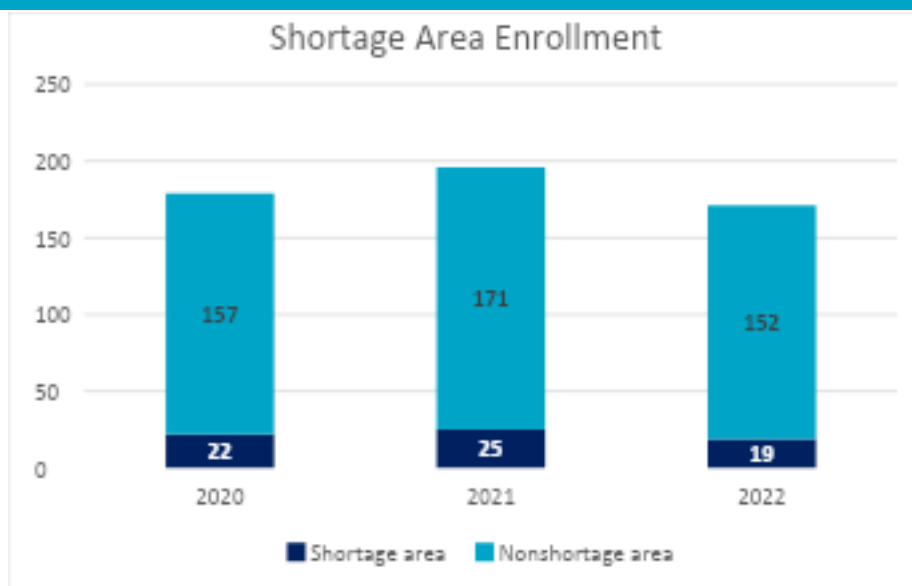
Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	-0.4%	APPROACHING



*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need

Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	12%	BELOW



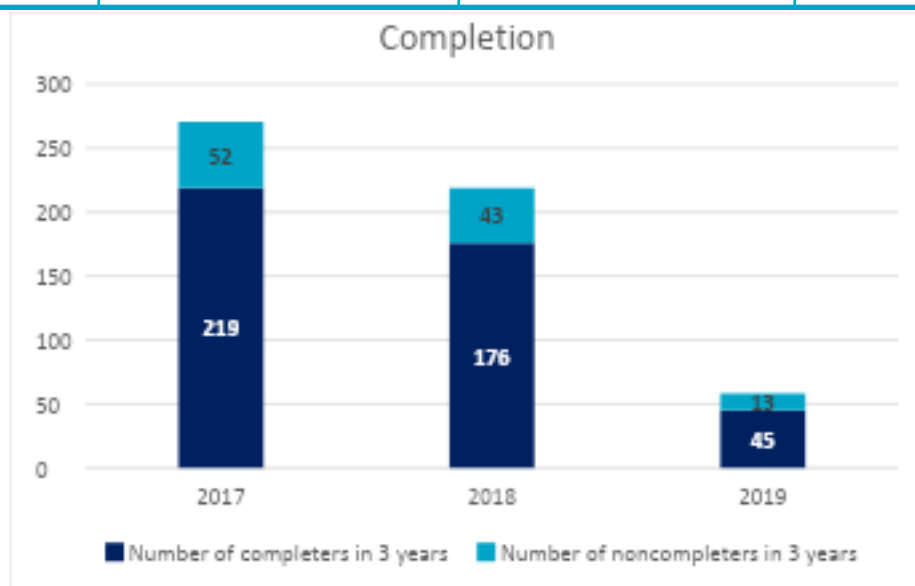
*Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas. Current licensure areas of shortage: Computer

Science (4-12), Biology (7-12), Chemistry (7-12), Physics (7-12), Foreign Language (K-12), Math (7-12), Math (4-8), Science (4-8), Special Education (K-12)

INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion

Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	74%	80%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	APPROACHING	MEETS
Recommendations		
The traditional program at Arkansas Tech University provided evidence to highlight its commitment to providing candidates with high-quality coursework that prepares them with the knowledge, systems and structures they need to teach in Arkansas schools, including grounding in HQIM and state teaching and academic standards. ATU offers a wide variety of clinical experiences thanks to its large number of district partnerships. Candidates receive regular feedback and support that prepares them to be effective in the classroom. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - By 2026–2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. ATU should make sure that its training program meets this bar, and that experienced mentor teachers receive ongoing professional development. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2b Metric 1 and Metric 4</i>) - Candidates would be better supported in their clinical internships with assigned clinical supervisors who have been thoughtfully trained to observe and provide more frequent high-quality feedback on teaching practice. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2c Metric 2 and Criteria 2.3b Metric 4</i>) - Arkansas Tech University should continue planning to meet the state's one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction
MEETS
Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction. In the evidence submitted through documentation, most of the coursework references best practices including Science of Reading; most of the middle and secondary education coursework explicitly references the use of HQIM and how to recognize and incorporate HQIM into unit planning. During the Course Instructor focus group, instructors from every level gave examples of how they implemented instruction with HQIM to teacher candidates. The instructors were familiar with their school library as a resource and said candidates have easy access to various HQIM in ATU's library and actively use them in their course assignments.

However, some of the teacher candidates felt as though their Science of Reading development was based more on theory than application, and some struggled to see a clear connection to the rest of their coursework. Within the three courses observed, reviewers recorded evidence of AR Academic K-12 Standards, HQIM implementation, and best practices such as aligning with AR initiatives in trauma-informed practices, modeling a variety of teaching techniques, and classroom engagement strategies. In the MLED course observation, reviewers noted, “the teacher refers to standards as a part of the lesson planning discussion. The teacher has HQIM resources in the classroom as they talk about Day 2 of their lesson design. She referred to differentiation as well as to IEPs for students.” In the SEED course observation, reviewers noted that the instructor weaves in K-12 Academic Standards. She uses examples and asks students to use the standards in lesson creation using the Backwards Design model.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

In the evidence provided, most of the coursework references an appropriate incorporation of AR Academic K-12 Standards. In the SEED course observations, reviewers noted, “The entire lesson tied in the Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards. The students started with the Standards and looked at how they might be used to create the goals and objectives for the lesson they were writing for their unit.” In the MLED course observation, reviewers noted, “The instructor talks about the importance of vertical and horizontal alignment when planning lessons, asking what students should be able to do to move to the next level.”

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants from all levels shared examples of how they incorporate the Arkansas Academic K-12 Standards and the expectations for integrating them throughout grade bands. In the Clinical Experiences focus group, one participant shared an assignment they had where they chose their content area and chose one area above and one below to become familiar with vertical alignment. Course instructors shared that candidates from every level are required to align to the K-12 Standards as they design lessons.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework. ATU courses include checkpoints for reinforcement opportunities for teaching candidates. The “Learning Progression” document submitted as evidence shows vertical integration of skills within the TESS domains; the major course assignments are examples of how teacher candidates create portfolios with reviews and revisions of artifacts. All teacher candidates create a portfolio throughout their time in the Teacher Education Program. In the Course Instructor focus group, one participant said, “We move deliberately from theory to methods to practice.” Instructors spoke about making sure that candidates are given “just in time” content to ensure a progression of skills.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area. In the documentation provided by ATU, reviewers noted that most course syllabi included intentional alignment between course objectives, AR Educator Competencies, and AR Teaching Standards. In the Course Instructor focus group, all instructors from all levels gave examples of how they design their courses to align to the Educator Competencies and to ATS. Some instructors spoke about how, over the past year, they visited various academic departments at ATU to ensure the EPP's courses accurately incorporated all the Competencies. They also added that even though the AR Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards were referenced in their syllabi by number, instructors explained to the students how to reference the Competencies and Standards the numbers represented.

In two of the three Coursework Observations, reviewers observed examples of Instructors incorporating the Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards. In one course, the lesson incorporated information on

trauma-informed practices to provide support and safety to families and students. This clearly aligns with Arkansas Teaching Standard #3: *The teacher works with others to create environments that support individual and collaborative learning, and that encourage positive social interaction, active engagement in learning, and self-motivation.* In a second course observation reviewers noted, “The instructor wrote the Arkansas Teaching Standards for the lesson on the board and used this as an example of what she used to design the lesson for that day. She reflected on those standards throughout the lesson as it relates to the students using the K-12 standards.”

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience and candidates have opportunities to reflect on the alignment with their course instructors and clinical supervisors. In all three course observations, reviewers noted instructors were relating the coursework to classroom experiences. For example, in one course the instructor aligned the trauma-informed practices to classroom experiences in multiple grade levels. At the end of the class, she asked for a reflection on how this may look in the classroom they will be observing in moving forward.

In the Clinical Experiences focus group, one participant gave the example of taking the course Technology in the Classroom and relayed how he is applying it in his field experience. In the Course Instructor focus group, one participant talked about the opportunity for reflection and that it is pulled into their final portfolio.

Reviewers heard evidence of the Course Instructors saying that in their coursework, the students “deliberately reflect on their teaching video using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric to align with what they are doing in the classroom. All candidates complete a professional growth plan that requires them to reflect and articulate their experience in alignment with coursework.”

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

APPROACHING

Some course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K-12 Academic standards, content knowledge and content pedagogy. In all three course observations, reviewers noted the course instructors implemented best practices and demonstrated knowledge of their content area and pedagogy.

While all course instructors have a terminal degree in a field aligned to educator preparation, fewer than half of the instructors have been trained in the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. Evidence of recent professional learning experiences is not specific for most instructors. In a discussion with ATU program leaders, they explained the yearly process for evaluating course instructors, but no evidence was provided to reviewers of sample or example evaluations.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors have a proven history and show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. In all three course observations, reviewers noted evidence of strong facilitation indicating the instructor gave good examples and connected with the teacher candidates. On the end of term survey ATU sends to teacher candidates, most responded positively to questions about their course instructors. For example, 81% of respondents rated their instructor’s overall performance as very good or excellent.

The coursework focus group said they receive a lot of feedback. Their professor “holds us to a really high standard... she puts in the effort, so we want to improve our efforts.” However, in the Coursework focus group, candidates’ perceptions around feedback differed greatly by program of study. A group of teacher candidates from one program felt as though the feedback they received was generic, not supportive and not constructive. This opinion was not held by all of the teaching candidates, but enough to warrant the distinction.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that

support their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. Checklists were provided in the evidence for each of the programs that describes that particular sequence. There are four levels throughout the teacher education experience with experiences and assignments that go along with each stage. Throughout a teacher candidate's participation in the program, many of the courses expect candidates to complete required classroom observation hours. In Stage I, candidates complete observation hours and in Stage II they begin a variety of clinical experience that gradually increases in responsibility. In the first semester, or Residency A, teacher candidates complete their upper-level coursework, while also teaching lessons in a classroom 3 days per week. In the second semester, Residency B, they serve as the full-time teacher, ideally in the same classroom they were part of in Residency A.

In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, all supervisors agreed that the sequence builds on previous experiences. For example, 20 hours were recently added to the program before starting Residency. One participant commented on how these hours provide opportunities for candidates to observe and learn the culture of a school before beginning teaching in residency A and B. In the Clinical Experiences focus group, some participants in one program noted that there have been many changes in program requirements lately, and for some, their Residency B was not as positive an experience as Residency A. They felt that Residency A was more rigorous and rewarding; however, overall candidates across most programs felt satisfied with their clinical experiences and thought they were sequenced in a meaningful way.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. Teacher candidates have multiple opportunities to observe classrooms throughout their participation in the ATU program (evidenced above in Metric 1). In SPED 3033, teacher candidates are required to complete an artifact that requires them to work with a student with an IEP or on a 504 plan. ATU's Director of Special Education reaches out to all experienced mentor teachers asking them to identify a student who meets these criteria for the teacher candidate to work with throughout the semester.

ATU partners with almost one-third of AR school districts. These extensive EPP-District partnerships enable their teacher candidates to visit multiple districts and grade levels throughout their grade band, which are required as part of the program. Additionally, in every course in Elementary Education, teacher candidates have a placement opportunity. In Clinical Experience focus groups, participants reported working with a variety of students in these placements, including students with IEPs and 504s, English Learners, Gifted and Talented students, and homeless students.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. In the survey document submitted, "Results Spring 2024," candidates responded to eight questions related to the effectiveness of their mentor teachers including actionable feedback, effective assessment, holding in person or virtual meetings. The response average was 4.7 out of 5, the most positive. In the "Intern Exit Survey," teacher candidates responded positively (4.7 out of 5) that "the mentor teacher with whom I was placed, modeled good teaching practices in line with four TESS domains" and "the mentor teacher benefited my growth and development as a future educator." Nearly all respondents who left comments on their mentor teacher were positive.

All teacher candidates have a campus-based supervisor OR an EPP supervisor and mentor teacher. The Reviewers who observed a coaching debrief with a teaching candidate mentioned the Cognitive Coaching questions that were asked and saw a clear focus on content sequence and management. In the Clinical Experience focus group, participants across all pathways agreed they had a positive experience with their mentor teacher. In the School

Partnership focus group, participants indicated that all experienced mentor teachers are equipped to provide supportive clinical experience for teacher candidates.

Mentor teachers are either a Cohort Mentor Teacher (completed ATU's Cohort Teacher Training, responsible for being the mentor teacher, and responsible for conducting formal observations), or they work as a Campus-based Supervisor (have not completed ATU's training and will work with an ATU Clinical Supervisor). The ATU Clinical Supervisor comes onsite for the formal evaluations, but the Campus Based Supervisor (mentor teacher) serves as the day-to-day mentor teacher.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers MEETS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers. The ATU TESS office coordinates placement with a school or district and the building principal identifies an experienced mentor teacher. During the EPP Partnership focus group, principals shared a set of criteria they use to select their mentor teachers including evaluation ratings, years of experience and value-add scores. Those selected as experienced mentor teachers by their principal are invited to complete ATU's Cohort Teacher Training.

Mentor teachers who successfully complete ATU's Cohort Teacher Training can then be selected as a Cohort Mentor Teacher to both mentor AND conduct formal observations.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors APPROACHING

Some program clinical supervisors have a proven history and show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. There are thirteen clinical supervisors, and all have completed ATU's Campus Based Supervisor training. However, no additional evidence was given about state-approved coach training or their experiences.

Coaching with a positive impact was seen in observations with one of the Clinical Supervisors. For example, instead of telling the teacher candidate what she needed to do differently, the supervisor directed her to that outcome through questioning. They also discussed ideas for how to shift group work expectations, how to structure the lesson for more efficiency, discussed what to "cut" and where to focus more attention. The Clinical Supervisor mentioned adolescent development and strategies that are developmentally appropriate for the fifth-grade students in the teacher candidate's class.

However, there was a variety of effectiveness seen and heard in other clinical observations. In one observation the clinical supervisor reminded the TC that she would be looking for levels of Bloom's Taxonomy; however, they were not discussed in the post observation. Other clinical observations were mixed in the amount of time spent in the post conference; one was six minutes.

In the Clinical Experiences focus group, seven out of twelve candidate participants had a clinical supervisor. Two had a cohort supervisor, and two had not had anyone assigned to them yet. Candidates reported a variety of experiences in terms of being observed and feeling as though the coaching from their clinical supervisor has had a positive impact. Four out of twelve said they had received feedback from being observed.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates APPROACHING

ATU has feedback structures in place, and teacher candidates receive high-quality feedback. There is evidence of structures set up to solicit regular feedback and coaching for each teacher candidate and evidence was observed of teacher candidates receiving both written and oral feedback. There is some evidence that feedback is connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric and that some coaches can identify key levers that will have the most impact on student learning. Sometimes the feedback was linked to student learning. There was some evidence that the feedback is linked to previous feedback. ATU does have guidance in place for experienced mentor teachers and clinical supervisors that explain the roles and responsibilities, the evaluation systems, and the deadlines. Reviewers saw evidence of four formal observations that occur throughout the semester. They follow the pre-observation, observation, and post-observation (POP) feedback cycle.

However, there was a range of experiences regarding consistency and frequency of teacher candidates receiving oral and written feedback from their experienced mentor teacher, campus-based supervisor, or clinical supervisor. They are formally evaluated four times per semester and informally given feedback by their experienced mentor teacher. The evidence provided included an Exit Portfolio which showed evidence of feedback. In an Intern Exit Survey, nearly 94% of respondents agreed with the statement “I received feedback to improve from my campus-based supervisor.” In one course observation the feedback consisted of mostly agreeing with what the teacher candidate stated when asked questions. It wasn’t clear if goals were set for the future. There was no evidence or mention of Aspiring Teacher Rubric.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place with most districts to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. ATU provided documented evidence of training for experienced mentor teachers, emails to secure teacher candidate placements, panel agendas that show collaboration between schools and ATU. In the EPP Partnership focus group, 100% of participants expressed satisfaction with the quality of their partnership with ATU. While there are not any formal communication structures in place, they reported communicating frequently via phone, text and email. They also noted that if there is an issue with a teacher candidate, the ATU TESS Office is very responsive, often resolving the issue within 24-48 hours.

ATU collaborates with school districts to meet the needs of school partners and teacher candidates. An example of this is the paraprofessional pathway to licensure. ATU teacher candidates can work as a paraprofessional in a partner school while completing their coursework. They will take online coursework, and their role as a paraprofessional can count as their residency experience. In the EPP Partnership focus group, the partner school district spoke highly of this program.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

APPROACHING

There are some collaborative processes that support and develop effective clinical supervisors. ATU includes Cohort Mentor Teachers and Campus-Based Supervisors in their definition of “clinical supervisors.” Cohort Mentor Teachers are required to complete training over the summer that includes information about their role, the feedback cycle and Aspiring Teacher Rubric. Cohort Mentor Teachers are paid by ATU while they serve in this role. There are other clinical supervisors who are faculty or adjunct at ATU who also receive training in their role.

There was no evidence provided of ongoing professional development for clinical supervisors and in Clinical Supervisor focus groups, participants in the Cohort Mentor Teachers role felt that communication is one way. Although they feel they can always reach out to the EPP with questions, there are no ongoing check ins, meetings, or development that the EPP initiates. The TESS Office maintains the evaluations and survey results for clinical supervisors; however, reviewers did not see results or the process if clinical supervisors did not have strong reviews.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. Over the last three cohorts, the average GPA has improved from admission to completion. In Spring 2024, the GPA at admission was 3.49 and at completion it was 3.63

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track. There is a clear progression timeline that teacher candidates must follow to advance to the next stage of the program. If a candidate falls off track, a support plan is created that is customized for them. The support plan includes clear action steps, implications if progress is not made and is discussed by the teacher candidate and their supervisors. Advisors play an important role in providing support throughout the program of study. Academic progress and program compliance (i.e. GPA, Course Completion) is monitored by advisors using Degree Works. The EPP partners with various offices on campus to provide support services including, but not limited to: supporting candidate learning disabilities, test anxiety, tutoring, Praxis Test Prep, and health services. Candidates who need academic support, for example, including ETS Praxis Prep are advised to seek services provided by [ATU TRIO](#).

In the Coursework focus group, participants mentioned that they receive feedback in Blackboard and five out of 12 also receive feedback from their course instructor through email. In the course instructor focus group, participants discussed the high numbers of teaching candidates who are first generation college students. The TRIO program helps with support, and they work closely with DESE and their Co-ops to provide support for licensure exams. Across all programs, course instructors talked about proactively reaching out to teaching candidates. For example, some instructors use the "Remind" app and in the AGED class, if they miss more than 2 classes, they follow up with students.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have a set of goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internships including observations aligned to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, minimum GPA to begin clinical internship, capstone projects, passing Praxis, and on track to licensure. There are four levels throughout the internship experience with goals, milestones and assignments that go along with each level. If the student is not making adequate progress after the mentor teacher has worked with them, which is unlikely, the mentor teacher contacts the Director of Teacher Education Student Services. Multiple examples of the exit portfolio were submitted as evidence and the average TESS and Aspiring Teacher Rubric data indicates that most candidates are successful.

Although ATU has a set of clear goals and milestones, and most candidates meet them, in the Clinical Experience focus group, only candidates in some programs know the goals and milestones for their program and if they are on track and meeting these goals. Some programs hold multiple meetings to discuss the tasks and artifacts for their exit portfolio, keep running checklists of completion, participate in a Webex chat group; however, in another program participants in the focus group did not feel as though they had clear directions or an understanding of what was being asked of them.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is some evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. In the Clinical Experience focus group, 100% of the participants reported experiences and opportunities to impact student growth. They provided examples such as leading reading groups, reteaching lessons during intervention time and the use of exit tickets and assessments. In the exit portfolio, teacher candidates take what was learned previously and apply it fully to a classroom in the public-school setting and reflect upon their impact on student learning by providing assessment results, discussing these assessment results, and considering student learning needs within the learning environment.

However, in all three of the coaching observations, none of the clinical supervisors asked about student data or growth, missing opportunities to reflect on this with their teacher candidate.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive a score of "effective" on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric at the end of their clinical internship. Over the course of four evaluations, all cohorts showed growth and the percentage of teacher candidates earning an effective rating increased. 54% of students in Spring 2024 cohort earned an effective rating during their first evaluation, 64% earned an effective rating and 29% earned a highly effective rating in their last evaluation. ATU transitioned to using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric in Fall 2023.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship
APPROACHING

Struggling candidates are sometimes provided with an individualized support plan if their development is not on track. The Office of Educator Licensure and Support Services provides a full range of services for students. The primary purpose is to assist students with requirements necessary to complete early field experiences, internships, and subsequently licensure. Responsiveness to students' needs is a primary goal of this office. This office provides well-planned and organized procedures in the areas of requirements for early field experiences, entry into internship, professional licensure processing, and general information dissemination.

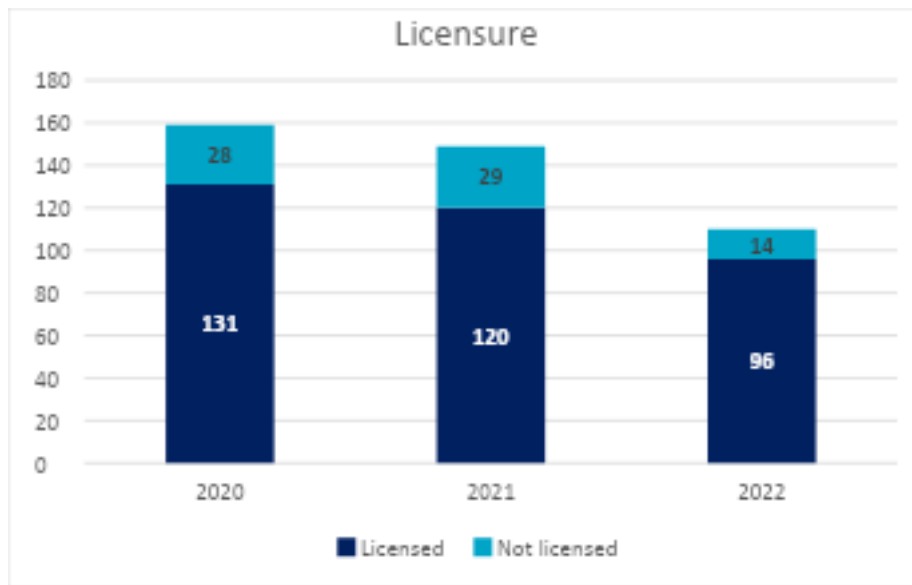
In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, supervisors mentioned providing help when needed, but did not specify specific examples beyond "provide resources, talk, and show them" or "falls on campus supervisor to provide support." In the Clinical Experience focus group, 5 of the 12 participants felt they received the support they needed to be successful. In the evidence provided, scholarships were mentioned as opportunities for high performing candidates that encourage retention; however, no specific evidence was provided in terms of how many candidates are awarded scholarships or the criteria for earning them.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Arkansas Tech University's traditional preparation program is meeting or exceeding state targets for nearly all metrics for Supporting Workforce Needs. Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that traditional program completers are prepared to pass the content exam on their first try. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1c)</i> - Support program completers to work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects to increase the percentage of licensed teachers who take this type of job in the first three years after completion. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.2b)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year after completion	76%	83%	EXCEEDS

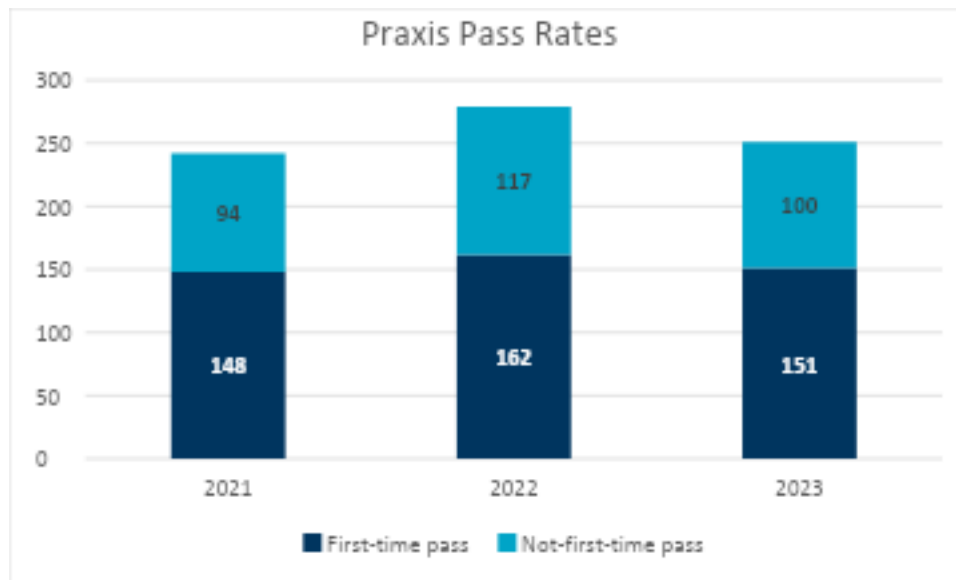


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	n/a	n/a

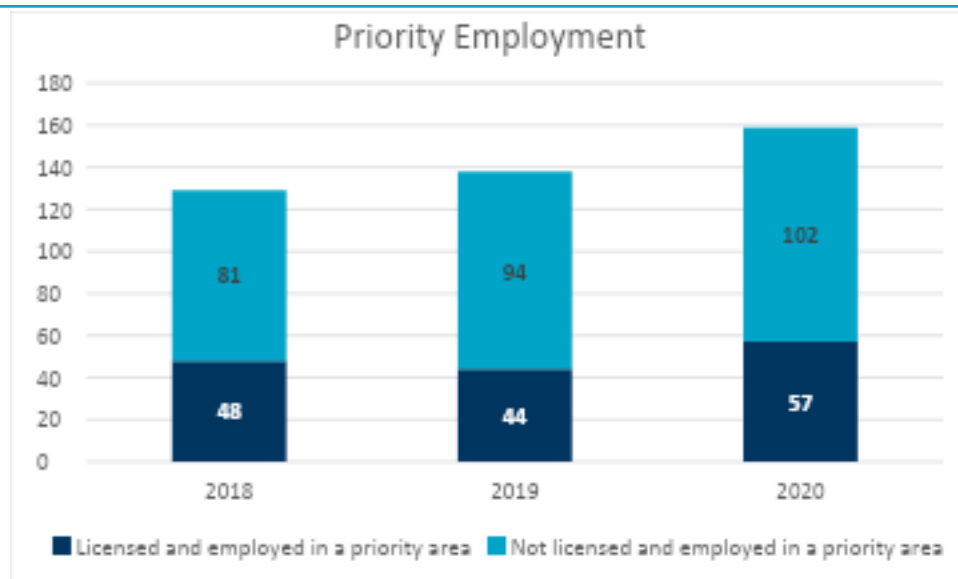
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the Praxis content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time Praxis licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	59.7%	APPROACHING



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	79.8%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and employed</th><th>Not licensed and employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2018</td><td>107</td><td>22</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>102</td><td>36</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>131</td><td>28</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed	2018	107	22	2019	102	36	2020	131	28
Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed													
2018	107	22													
2019	102	36													
2020	131	28													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	35%	APPROACHING												



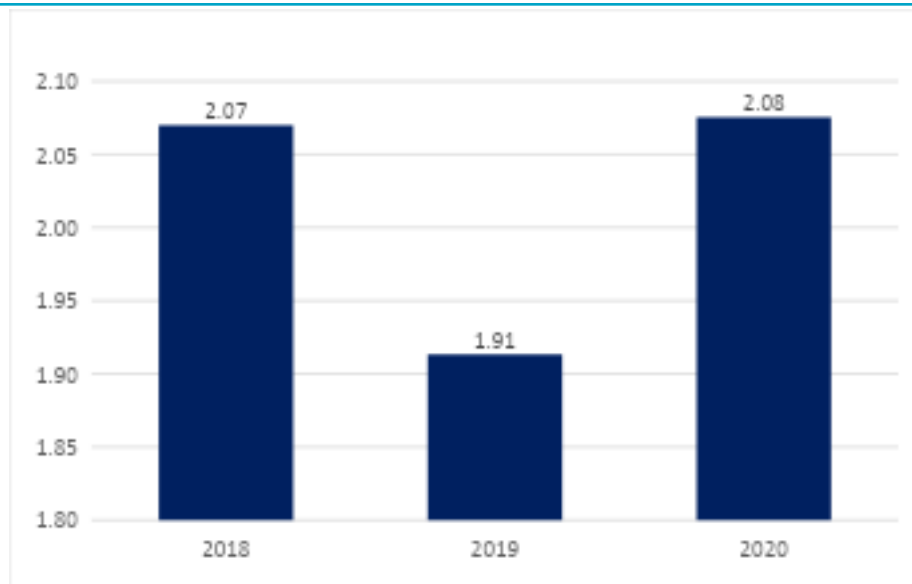
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	2.02	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	81%	83.9%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	75%	72.7%	MEETS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	38%	MEETS

Value-Added Growth Scores

